Day 08

Kipper's Christmas Eve

Mick Inkpen

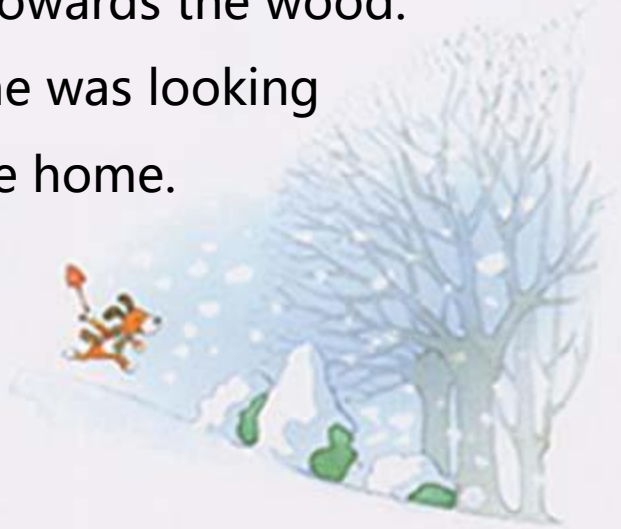
小狗Kipper“咯吱咯吱”地踏着雪，去寻找自己的圣诞树。它在想，到底是圣诞节好玩还是平安夜好玩儿呢？好玩在收到礼物的瞬间还是期待礼物的过程？小朋友你说呢~

"Which is best? " said Kipper to himself.

"Christmas Day? Or Christmas Eve? "

He reached the top of Big Hill and stopped.

"Presents? Or expecting presents? "
And then, because he was too excited to decide, he just whooped , and went charging down the slope towards the wood. It was Christmas Eve and he was looking for a Christmas tree to take home.

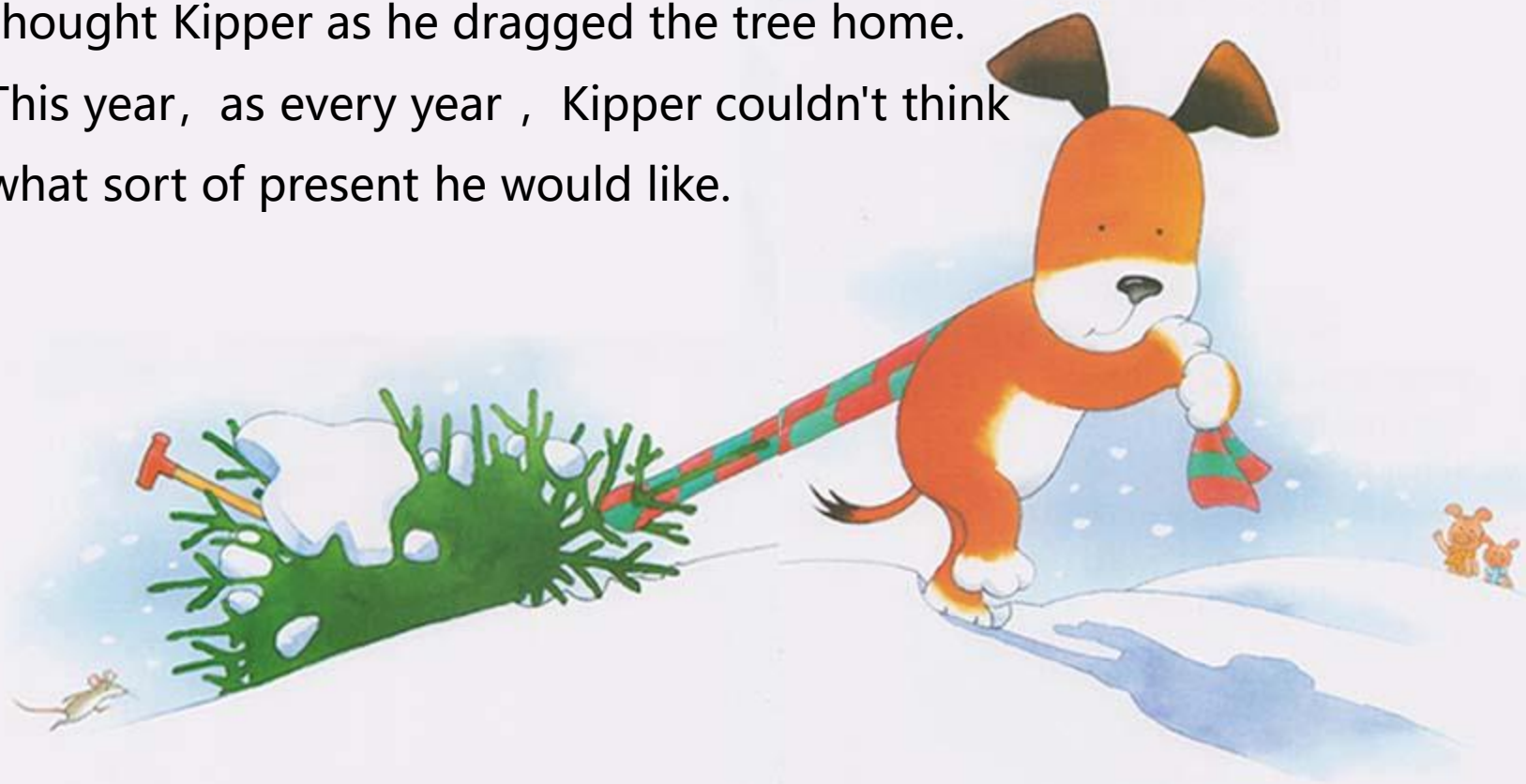


In the middle of the wood was a little fir tree. "That's the one！" said Kipper. He dug away the snow with his spade. Then he grabbed the tree and pulled. It wouldn't come.

He pushed it，shook it，twisted and lifted it.
Then he looped his scarf around it，and
heaved，and heaved，and heaved，until ...

It did!

"I wonder what Father Christmas will bring me? "
thought Kipper as he dragged the tree home.
This year, as every year , Kipper couldn't think
what sort of present he would like.

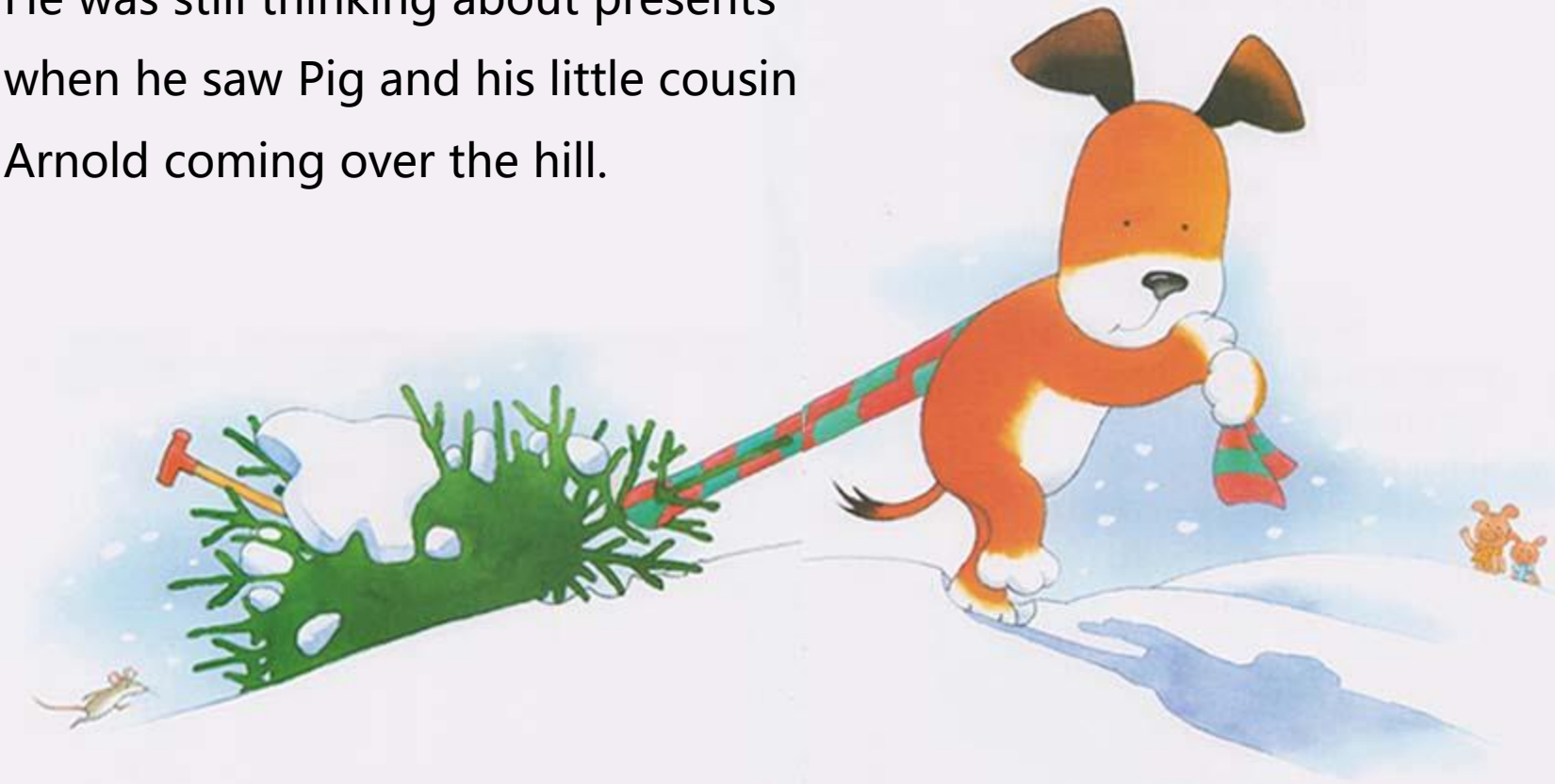


"I expect I'll know what I want when I see what it is，"said Kipper.

He was still thinking about presents

when he saw Pig and his little cousin

Arnold coming over the hill.



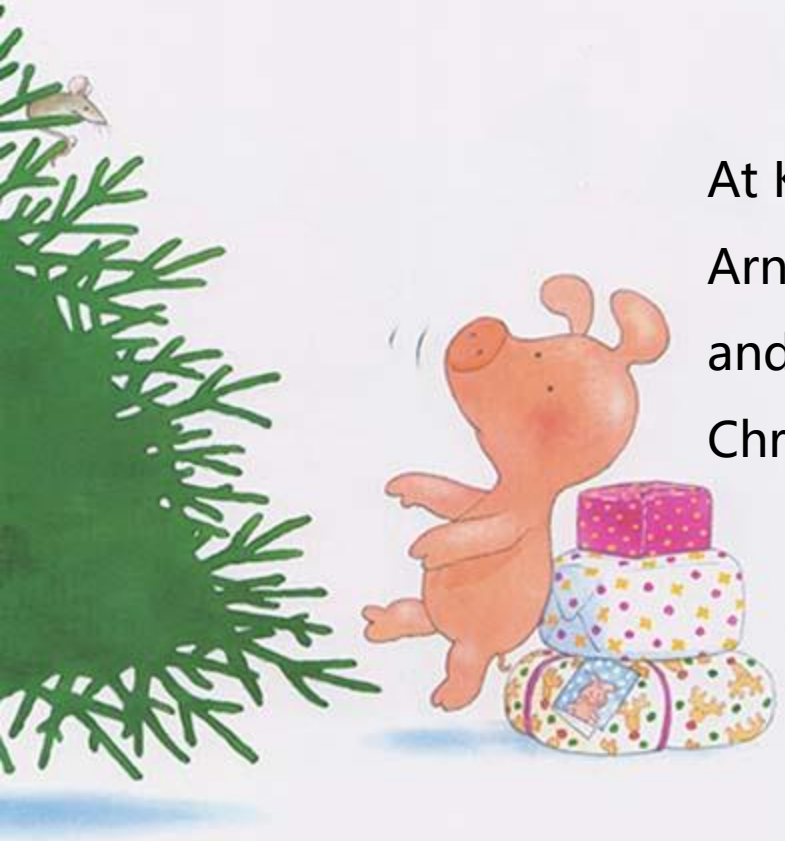
"Hello Kipper! " said Pig.

"Do you want a hand with that? "

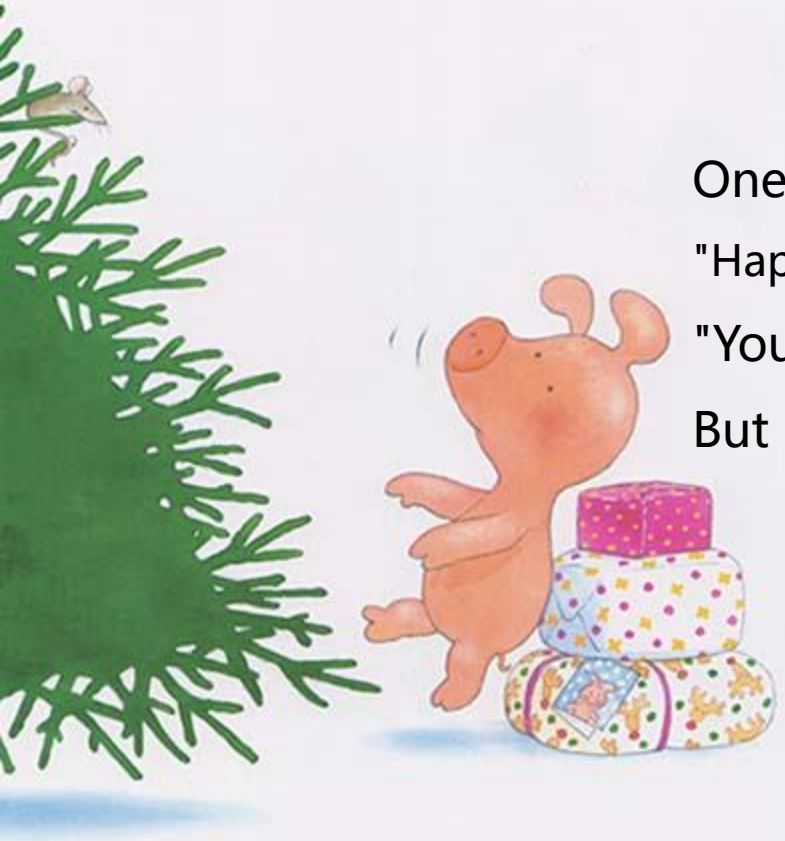
Pig tied his own scarf to the fir tree and together they heaved it up the slope, while Arnold toddled along behind, sucking his thumb.

He was pointing at something in the tree.

But Kipper and Pig were too busy talking about presents to notice.



At Kipper's house they stood the tree in a bucket. Arnold peered into the branches，walking round and round the tree，until he bumped into a pile of Christmas presents.



One of them had a label with his name on it.

"Happy Christmas，Arnold. Love from Kipper，" it said.

"You mustn't open that until tomorrow！" said Pig.

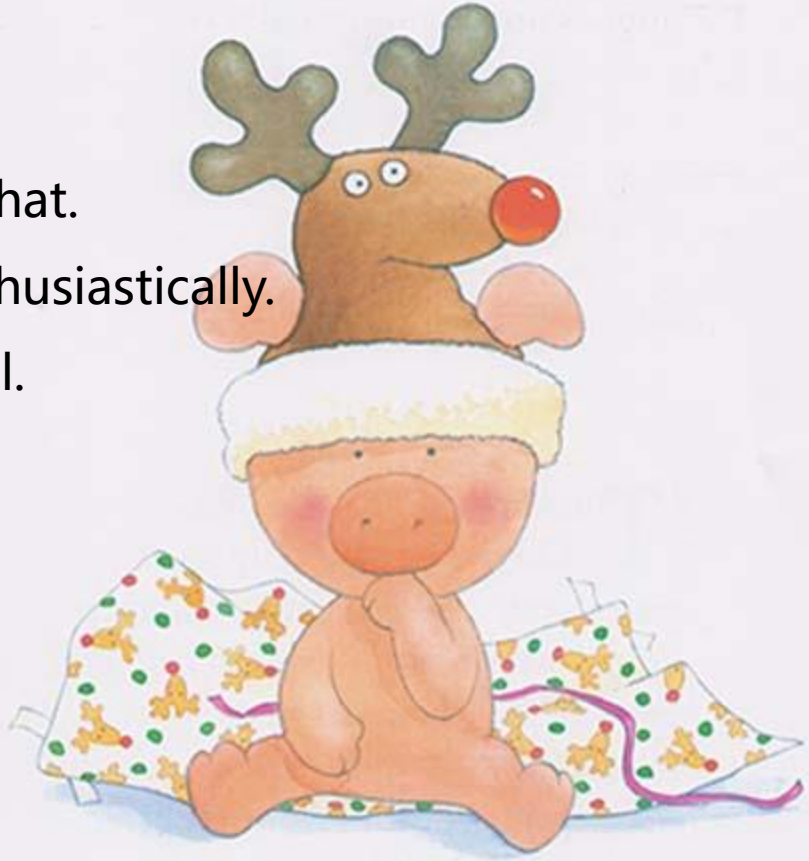
But he already had.

Kipper's present to Arnold was a reindeer hat.

"The red nose lights up！" said Kipper enthusiastically.

"And it flashed too！"But then his face fell.

He had forgotten to buy the batteries.



Arnold didn't mind. He loved his hat，even without its battery operated flashing red nose.

"That reminds me! " said Pig.

"I haven't wrapped up your present yet! "

So Pig went home, while Arnold stayed with Kipper to help him decorate the Christmas tree.

"What shall we put on top, Arnold? "

said Kipper. "A snowman? Or a star? "

But Arnold didn't seem to be interested in the decorations.

Arnold climbed on to the stool，took off his hat，and plopped it over the mouse. The stool wobbled and fell over.

"Are you all right，Arnold？"said Kipper. Arnold sat up and pointed. Kipper looked at the reindeer hat sitting on top of the Christmas tree.

"Clever old you！" he said to Arnold. "It's just right！

"And so it was.

Just as they finished decorating the tree, the doorbell rang. It was Tiger. He had come to wish Kipper a Merry Christmas. And to throw a snowball at him.

Pig arrived too. "Sorry it's a bit lumpy." said Pig，
handing Kipper his present.
"I'm not very good at wrapping thing up."
"I like lumpy present，" said Kipper.
"It makes you wonder what's inside."

"Time to go home，" said Pig to Arnold.

Kipper took Arnold's hat from the tree and gave it back to him.

Arnold looked inside. There was no mouse.

"Merry Christmas，Kipper！" said Pig.

"Merry Christmas，Kipper！" said Tiger.

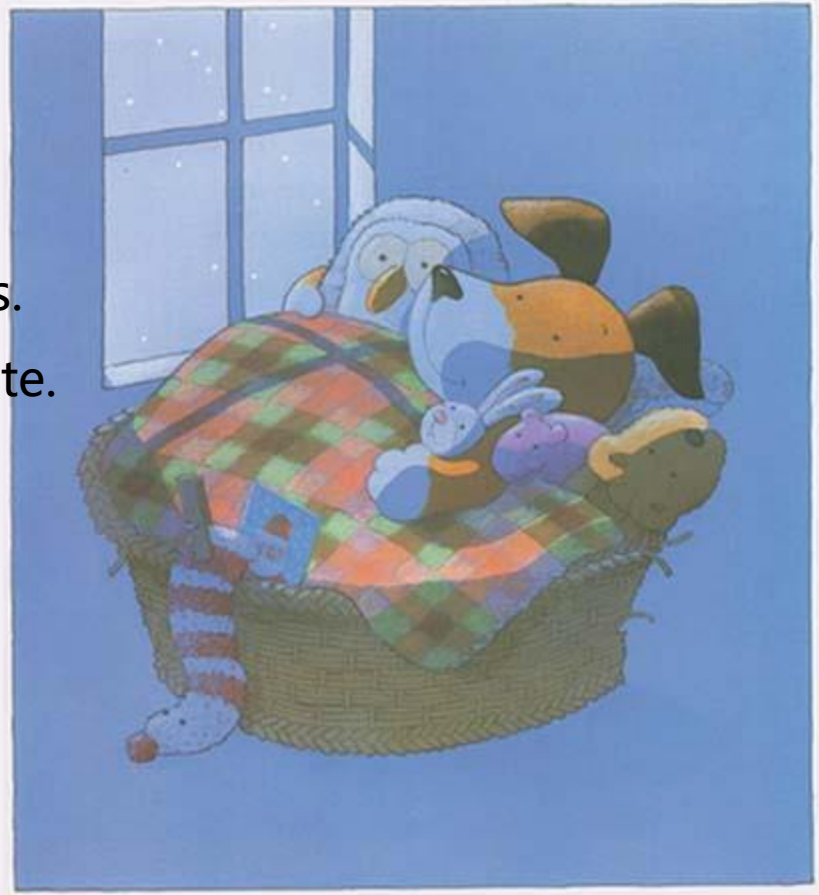
"Merry Christmas，everyone！" said Kipper，

as they walked out into the snow.

"Look out for Father Christmas！"

Arnold waved and looked inside his hat once more，just to make sure there really was nothing there.

"I think Christmas Eve is best，"said Kipper，
putting out some biscuits for Father Christmas.
He pegged Sock Thing to his basket with a note.



"To Father Christmas. Anything please. Thank you. Love from Kipper."

He pulled the blanket up and lay staring out of the window at the stars.

He was wide awake. He wasn't sleepy at all. He couldn't wait for Father Christmas to come ...

"Which is best？" said Kipper to himself. "Christmas Day？Or Christmas Eve？" He reached the top of Big Hill and stopped.

"Presents？Or expecting presents？ "And then，because he was too excited to decide，he just whooped，and went charging down the slope towards the wood.

It was Christmas Eve and he was looking for a Christmas tree to take home.

“哪个最好？”Kipper自言自语着，“圣诞节？还是圣诞前夕？”他到达Big Hill的山顶，停下来。

“礼物？还是期待礼物？”接着，因为太过兴奋， 没法决定，他只是大叫了一声，就电力十足地向斜坡下的树林冲去。

此时，是圣诞前夕，他想找一棵圣诞树带回家。

In the middle of the wood was a little fir tree.
"That's the one！" said Kipper. He dug away the snow with his spade. Then he grabbed the tree and pulled. It wouldn't come.

He pushed it，shook it，twisted and lifted it. Then he looped his scarf around it，and heaved，and heaved，and heaved，until ...

在树林中间，有一棵小冷杉。“就是它了！”kipper说。他用铲子把雪挖开。然后，他抓着树，开始拉。它一动也不动。

他推它，摇它，扭它，提它。然后，他用他的围巾绕着它，用力，用力，用力，直到....

It did！
小树被拔出来了！

"I wonder what Father Christmas will bring me？" thought Kipper as he dragged the tree home.
This year，as every year ，Kipper couldn't think what sort of present he would like.

"I expect I'll know what I want when I see what it is，"said Kipper.
He was still thinking about presents when he saw Pig and his little cousin Arnold coming over the hill.

“我很好奇，圣诞老人会给我带什么？”Kipper一边想着，一边拽着这棵树回家。今年，和每年一样，Kipper想不出来，他想要哪种礼物。

“我希望在我看到它是什么的时候，我能够知道我想要什么。”Kipper说。当他看到Pig和他的小表弟Arnold朝山这边走来的时候，他还在想礼物的事情。

"Hello Kipper！" said Pig.
"Do you want a hand with that？"
Pig tied his own scarf to the fir tree and together they heaved it up the slope，while Arnold toddled along behind，sucking his thumb.
He was pointing at something in the tree. But Kipper and Pig were too busy talking about presents to notice.

“你好，Kipper！”Pig说：“需要帮忙么？”
Pig把他自己的围巾绑在这棵冷杉上，两人一起用力把它拖上山坡Arnold则摇摇摆摆地跟在后面，吸着手指。

他指着树上的什么东西。但是Kipper和Pig在忙着聊礼物的事，根本没注意到。

At Kipper's house they stood the tree in a bucket. Arnold peered into the branches，walking round and round the tree，until he bumped into a pile of Christmas presents.

One of them had a label with his name on it. "Happy Christmas，Arnold. Love from Kipper，" it said.
"You mustn't open that until tomorrow！" said Pig. But he already had.

在Kipper家，他们把这棵树放进一个桶里。Arnold围着这棵树，转来转去地朝树枝里瞧，直到他跌倒在一堆圣诞礼物里。

其中一个礼物的标签上，有他的名字。“圣诞快乐，Arnold。Kipper敬上。”标签上写着。“明天没到，你不能打开！”Pig说。但是他已经打开了。

Kipper's present to Arnold was a reindeer hat.
"The red nose lights up！" said Kipper enthusiastically.
"And it flashed too！"But then his face fell. He had forgotten to buy the batteries.

Arnold didn't mind. He loved his hat，even without its battery operated flashing red nose.

Kipper给Arnold的礼物是一个驯鹿帽。“这个红鼻子会亮哦！”Kipper激动地说。“他还会闪哦！”接着，他的脸拉了下来。他忘买电池了。

Arnold不介意。就算没有电池，红鼻子不闪，他也喜欢他的帽子。

"That reminds me！" said Pig. "I haven't wrapped up your present yet！" So Pig went home，while Arnold stayed with Kipper to help him decorate the Christmas tree.

"What shall we put on top, Arnold? "said Kipper. "A snowman? Or a star? " But Arnold didn't seem to be interested in the decorations.

“这倒提醒了我！”Pig说。“我还没有给你的礼物打包呢！”于是，Pig回家去了，Arnold则留下来，和Kipper一起，帮他装饰圣诞树。

“我们放什么在树顶好呢，Arnold?”Kipper说。“一个雪人？还是一颗星星？”但是，Arnold好像对装饰并不感兴趣。

Arnold climbed on to the stool，took off his hat，and plopped it over the mouse. The stool wobbled and fell over.

Arnold爬上一个凳子，拿下他的帽子，盖在一只小老鼠上。凳子晃了晃，然后倒了。

"Are you all right，Arnold？"said Kipper. Arnold sat up and pointed. Kipper looked at the reindeer hat sitting on top of the Christmas tree.
"Clever old you！" he said to Arnold.
"It's just right！"And so it was.
“你没事吧，Arnold？”Kipper问。Arnold坐起来，指了指。
Kipper看到那个驯鹿帽子，戴在了圣诞树的树顶上。
“你真聪明！”Kipper对Arnold说：“这样真棒！”就这样啦！

Just as they finished decorating the tree, the doorbell rang. It was Tiger. He had come to wish Kipper a Merry Christmas. And to throw a snowball at him.
他们刚刚装饰好圣诞树，门铃响了。是Tiger。他是来祝Kipper圣诞快乐的。还朝Kipper扔了一个雪球。

Pig arrived too.
"Sorry it's a bit lumpy." said Pig，handing Kipper his present.
"I'm not very good at wrapping thing up."
"I like lumpy present，" said Kipper.
"It makes you wonder what's inside."
Pig也回来了。“不好意思，这礼物包的疙疙瘩瘩的。”他把礼物递给Kipper。
Pig说，“我不太会包装东西。”
“我喜欢这样疙疙瘩瘩的礼物，”Kipper说，“这会让我很想知道，里面装着什么。”

"Time to go home，" said Pig to Arnold.
Kipper took Arnold's hat from the tree and gave it back to him.
Arnold looked inside. There was no mouse.

"Merry Christmas，Kipper！" said Pig.
"Merry Christmas，Kipper！" said Tiger.
"Merry Christmas，everyone！" said Kipper，as they walked out into the snow. "Look out for Father Christmas！"

“该回家啦！”Pig对Arnold说。
Kipper从树顶上拿下驯鹿帽子，递给Arnold。Arnold朝帽子里看看，没有老鼠。

“圣诞快乐，Kipper！”Pig说。
“圣诞快乐，Kipper！”Tiger说。
“你们也圣诞快乐！”当大家走入外面的雪地时，Kipper说，“看看有没有圣诞老人啊！”

Arnold waved and looked inside his hat once more，just to make sure there really was nothing there.

Arnold挥挥手，然后又看看他的帽子里面，想要确认他的帽子里确实什么都没有。

"I think Christmas Eve is best，"said Kipper，putting out some biscuits for Father Christmas.
He pegged Sock Thing to his basket with a note.

“我觉得，还是平安夜最好。”Kipper说着，为圣诞老人准备了一些饼干。他把袜子钉在篮子里，贴了一张纸条。

"To Father Christmas. Anything please. Think you. Love from Kipper."
He pulled the blanket up and lay staring out of the window at the stars. He was wide awake.He wasn't sleepy at all. He couldn't wait for Father Christmas to come ...

字条上写着：“圣诞老人，什么礼物都可以。谢谢你。爱你的Kipper。”Kipper盖好毯子，躺在篮子里，凝视着窗外的星空。他很清醒，一点都不想睡觉。他已经快等不及圣诞老人的到来了。